

ORGANIZATIONAL NETWORK ANALYSIS

Cone Spring Ecosystem

A Quantitative Assessment Using
Ulanowicz-Fath Regenerative Economics Principles

Report Date: July 03, 2026

Adaptive Organization Analysis System

Network Nodes	Active Connections	Viability Status	Robustness
5	10	Viable	0.317

Executive Summary

Viability Status Viability	Robustness (R) High	Network Efficiency Optimal	Rel. Ascendency (α) Warning
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This report presents a comprehensive network analysis of **Cone Spring Ecosystem** using the Ulanowicz-Fath regenerative economics framework. The organization's network comprises **5 nodes** and **10 directed connections**, with a total system throughput of **17509.0 units**.

The system operates within the window of viability ($\alpha = 0.577$, bounds: 5309.89–15929.68), indicating sustainable operational characteristics. Robustness of $R = 0.317$ suggests high resilience to perturbations.

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1. Introduction

1.1 Engagement Context

This report presents the findings of a comprehensive network sustainability assessment of Cone Spring Ecosystem, conducted using the Ulanowicz-Fath regenerative economics framework. The framework applies information-theoretic principles originally developed for ecological network analysis to organizational systems, providing quantitative measures of system health, efficiency, and resilience that complement traditional performance indicators.

The business rationale for this approach is straightforward. Conventional performance metrics capture what an organization achieves at a point in time; they rarely illuminate whether the underlying network of flows -- information, resources, decisions -- is configured for long-term viability. The regenerative economics lens addresses this gap by measuring the balance between constraining efficiency and adaptive flexibility, a balance that decades of ecological research have shown to be the hallmark of sustainable systems (Ulanowicz, 2009; Fath et al., 2019).

1.2 Theoretical Foundation

The framework treats organizations as flow networks in which resources or information move between nodes (departments, teams, or individuals). Sustainability is modeled through two complementary quantities. Ascendency (A) captures the degree of organized, purposeful flow, calculated as the product of total system throughput and the average mutual information among flows. Development capacity (C) represents the theoretical upper bound of organization, derived from total throughput and the Shannon entropy of the flow distribution. The ratio $\alpha = A / C$ indicates what fraction of the system's potential is channeled into structured behavior; the complement, overhead, represents reserve capacity available for adaptation and recovery.

Empirical studies of ecological and economic networks have identified a window of viability -- a range of alpha values within which systems demonstrate sustainable dynamics. Systems below the lower bound lack sufficient coherence; those above the upper bound sacrifice adaptive capacity for short-term efficiency and become brittle.

1.3 Scope and Objectives

This assessment of Cone Spring Ecosystem pursues four objectives: first, to quantify the organization's position relative to the window of viability; second, to evaluate the balance between efficiency and resilience; third, to characterize the structural architecture of information flows; and fourth, to translate quantitative findings into prioritized, actionable recommendations for organizational leadership.

2. Methodology

2.1 Data and Network Construction

The analysis is based on a weighted directed flow matrix representing Cone Spring Ecosystem. The network comprises 5 organizational units connected by 10 active flow relationships, with a total system throughput of 17509.00 units. The data source is classified as: Organizational flow data.

Each cell F_{ij} of the matrix records the magnitude of flow from unit i to unit j . Flows may represent information exchange, resource allocation, decision authority, communication frequency, or material and energy transfer depending on the organizational context.

2.2 What Each Measure Captures

The analytical framework computes several families of indicators, each addressing a distinct question about organizational health.

2.2.1 Scale and Diversity

Total System Throughput (TST) measures the aggregate volume of all flows -- the overall scale of network activity. Flow Diversity (H) captures how evenly those flows are distributed: a high value indicates many pathways of comparable intensity, while a low value suggests concentration through a few dominant channels.

2.2.2 Organization and Capacity

Ascendency (A) quantifies how much of the network's activity is organized into purposeful, constrained pathways. Development Capacity (C) represents the theoretical maximum organization the network could achieve. The ratio $\alpha = A / C$ expresses current organization as a fraction of potential. Overhead ($\Phi = C - A$) measures the reserve capacity available for adaptation, learning, and recovery from disruption.

2.2.3 Sustainability Position

The Window of Viability defines the range of α values associated with sustainable system dynamics, empirically bounded at 0.20 (minimum coherence) and 0.60 (maximum efficiency before brittleness onset). Robustness ($R = -\alpha \times \log_2(\alpha)$) peaks at α approximately equal to 0.37, the theoretical optimum for balancing order with flexibility.

2.2.4 Network Architecture

Effective Link Density measures the proportion of possible connections that are active. Trophic Depth indicates how many hierarchical levels information traverses. Redundancy captures the availability of alternative pathways should primary channels be disrupted. Regenerative Capacity integrates overhead with proximity to the optimal balance point.

2.3 Validation

All calculations conform to the theoretical bounds established in the literature: $0 \leq \text{AMI} \leq \log_2(n)$, $0 \leq \alpha \leq 1$, and $0 \leq R \leq \log_2(e)/e$ (approximately 0.531). Computations use base-2 logarithms consistent with Ulanowicz's NETWRK 4.2 specifications. Full formula definitions are provided in the Appendix.

3. Results

3.1 Core Network Metrics

Metric	Value	Interpretation
Total System Throughput (TST)	17509.000	System scale
Average Mutual Information (AMI)	0.875	bits
Flow Diversity (H)	1.516	bits
Ascendency (A)	15326.681	57.7% of capacity
Development Capacity (C)	26549.468	100% (theoretical max)
Overhead (Φ)	11222.786	42.3% of capacity
Robustness (R)	0.317	High
Network Efficiency	0.577	Optimal
Redundancy	0.423	Moderate
Effective Link Density	0.109	ratio
Trophic Depth	1.700	levels
Regenerative Capacity	0.251	Moderate

Table 1. Core Network Metrics — Key information-theoretic and organizational measures derived from the Ulanowicz-Fath framework, with interpretive assessments for each indicator.

3.2 Sustainability Assessment

Parameter	Value	Status
Current Position (α)	0.577	Efficient
Lower Bound	5309.894	FAIL
Upper Bound	15929.681	PASS
Within Window of Viability	Yes	Sustainable

Table 2. Viability Assessment — Position of the organization relative to the empirically derived window of viability, indicating whether current efficiency-resilience dynamics are sustainable.

3.4 Flow Distribution Analysis

Statistic	Value
Mean Flow	1750.900
Median Flow	502.500
Standard Deviation	2566.375
Coefficient of Variation	1.466
Maximum Flow	8881.000
Gini Coefficient	0.650

Table 3. Flow Distribution Statistics — Summary of resource flow concentration and inequality across the network, including Gini coefficient and entropy-based dispersion measures.

The Gini coefficient of 0.650 indicates high inequality in flow distribution across the network.

4. OASIS Organizational Health Assessment

The OASIS framework assesses organizational health across five dimensions derived from Fath et al.'s (2019) 10 Principles of Regenerative Economics. The overall health score is **73/100** (HEALTHY).

Dimension	Score	Status	Key Focus
OPEN	55	HEALTHY	Interconnectivity & exchange
AUTONOMOUS	83	HEALTHY	Learning & routine encoding
SYMBIOTIC	68	HEALTHY	Integration & balance
INTELLIGENT	63	HEALTHY	Functional diversity
SUSTAINABLE	95	HEALTHY	Order-freedom balance

Table 4. OASIS Organizational Health Profile — Composite scores across the five OASIS dimensions (Open, Autonomous, Symbiotic, Intelligent, Sustainable), with status indicators benchmarked against healthy-system thresholds.

4.1 Dimension Interpretations

OPEN

Moderate interconnectivity (score: 55/100). The organization has reasonable connectivity but could improve cross-functional collaboration and information sharing.

AUTONOMOUS

Strong learning capacity (score: 83/100). The organization effectively encodes routines and shows healthy feedback loops for continuous improvement.

SYMBIOTIC

Moderate role integration (score: 68/100). Some imbalance in resource distribution or cooperation patterns. Consider addressing flow inequalities and fostering reciprocal relationships.

INTELLIGENT

Moderate functional diversity (score: 63/100). Some role differentiation exists but could be enhanced. Consider developing more specialized capabilities.

SUSTAINABLE

Excellent sustainability balance (score: 95/100). The organization operates within the Window of Viability ($\alpha=0.577$). Order and flexibility are well balanced.

4.2 OASIS-Based Recommendations

Recommendation 1 (MEDIUM priority)

- **Dimension:** SYMBIOTIC

- **Issue:** High resource inequality
- **Action:** Redistribute resources and responsibilities more equitably
- **Metrics to improve:** gini_coefficient, mutualism_ratio

Recommendation 2 (MEDIUM priority)

- **Dimension:** INTELLIGENT
- **Issue:** Insufficient functional differentiation
- **Action:** Develop specialized capabilities and clearer role definitions
- **Metrics to improve:** number_of_roles, functional_diversity

5. Benchmarking & Position

The organization's relative ascendancy is $\alpha = 0.577$, placing it within the Window of Viability (viable band 0.2–0.6; robustness optimum $\alpha \approx 0.37$). Distance to the robustness optimum is **0.209**.

Published ecosystem values below are scientific reference points for the viability scale—not organizational targets.

Reference Network	Relative Ascendancy (α)	Source
Cone Spring Original	0.505	Ulanowicz & Norden 1990
Cone Spring Eutrophicated	0.529	Ulanowicz et al. 2009
Crystal River Creek	0.552	Ulanowicz 1986
Florida Bay	0.367	Heymans et al. 2002

Table 5. Published reference networks (relative ascendancy). Shown as scientific reference points, not targets.

6. Risk & Resilience Analysis

Overall fragility classification: **balanced**. Adaptive reserve indicators — overhead ratio 42.3%, redundancy 0.423.

MEDIUM — Approaching upper viability bound

Evidence: $\alpha = 0.577$ is within 0.05 of 0.6.

Implication: Trend toward rigidity warrants monitoring.

LOW — System operates within the Window of Viability

Evidence: Relative ascendancy $\alpha = 0.577$ lies within $[0.2, 0.6]$.

Implication: Healthy balance of efficiency and resilience; maintain and monitor.

7. Prioritized Action Roadmap

7.1 Immediate (0–3 months)

No actions in this horizon.

7.2 Short-Term (3–9 months)

No actions in this horizon.

7.3 Medium-Term (9–18 months)

MEDIUM · SYMBIOTIC

Issue: High resource inequality

Action: Redistribute resources and responsibilities more equitably

Expected impact: Rebalances resource distribution and cooperation.

Metrics to improve: gini_coefficient, mutualism_ratio

MEDIUM · INTELLIGENT

Issue: Insufficient functional differentiation

Action: Develop specialized capabilities and clearer role definitions

Expected impact: Increases functional diversity and specialization.

Metrics to improve: number_of_roles, functional_diversity

8. ESG Framework Mapping

Indicative crosswalk linking OASIS findings to recognized disclosure frameworks (GRI, ESRS/CSRD, TCFD). Provided for navigation and context only; not a compliance attestation.

OASIS Finding	GRI	ESRS / CSRD	TCFD
OPEN Open (interconnectivity and information circulation): score 55/100, status HEALTHY.	GRI 2-9/2-29 (governance, stakeholder engagement)	ESRS 2 GOV/SBM (strategy & stakeholder interaction)	Governance (board oversight of interconnected risks)
AUTONOMOUS Autonomous (organizational learning and feedback): score 83/100, status HEALTHY.	GRI 3-3 (management of material topics)	ESRS 2 IRO (impact, risk & opportunity management)	Risk Management (processes to identify/learn)
SYMBIOTIC Symbiotic (resource equity and mutualism): score 68/100, status HEALTHY.	GRI 3-3 / 207 (equitable value distribution)	ESRS S/G (own workforce, business conduct)	Strategy (resource dependencies)
INTELLIGENT Intelligent (functional diversity and capability): score 63/100, status HEALTHY.	GRI 2-17 (collective knowledge of governance body)	ESRS 2 GOV (skills/expertise of administrative bodies)	Governance (competencies to assess risk)
SUSTAINABLE Sustainable (efficiency/resilience balance (Window of Viability)): score 95/100, status HEALTHY.	GRI 201-2 (financial implications/risks of change)	ESRS 2 SBM-3 (resilience of strategy & business model)	Strategy — Resilience (scenario/long-term viability)

Table 6. Indicative OASIS-to-ESG framework crosswalk.

9. Discussion

4.1 Strategic Assessment

The analysis of Cone Spring Ecosystem yields a clear overall picture: the organization maintains a configuration consistent with sustainable dynamics.

The principal strengths identified are viability positioning ($\alpha = 0.577$ within the sustainable window); strong robustness ($R = 0.317$); substantial overhead reserves (42.3% of capacity). These characteristics indicate that the organization has achieved the kind of efficiency-resilience balance that ecological and economic research associates with long-term viability.

4.2 Comparative Positioning

Empirical benchmarks from ecological and organizational literature provide useful context. Sustainable ecological food webs typically exhibit α in the range 0.20 to 0.50 (Ulanowicz, 2009). High-performing organizations analyzed using the same framework show α between 0.30 and 0.45 (Fath et al., 2019). The current system's α of 0.577 deviates from the high-performing organizational benchmark.

The ratio of ascendancy to overhead ($A/\Phi = 1.366$) provides additional insight. This ratio reflects the balance between structured throughput and adaptive reserves, consistent with Holling's (1973) adaptive cycle theory which holds that systems must invest in reserve capacity to sustain long-term functionality.

The flow diversity utilization -- the ratio of observed diversity to the theoretical maximum -- stands at 32.7%. This indicates that Cone Spring Ecosystem employs a limited fraction of its potential communication channels, suggesting opportunity to broaden information pathways.

4.3 Limitations and Caveats

Several limitations should be considered when interpreting these findings.

The analysis represents a single point in time. Organizational networks evolve, and a longitudinal series of assessments would reveal trajectory and stability patterns that a snapshot cannot capture. The meaning assigned to flows -- whether information, resources, or influence -- affects interpretation; mixed flow types within a single matrix may obscure dynamics specific to one category. The system boundary and level of node aggregation also influence metric values; alternative boundary definitions could yield different insights. Finally, while the analysis reveals structural patterns and their likely implications, causal claims require controlled intervention studies.

10. Conclusions & Recommendations

5.1 Summary of Findings

This assessment of Cone Spring Ecosystem establishes that the organization operates within the window of viability, demonstrating the efficiency-resilience balance associated with sustainable network dynamics. Robustness of $R = 0.317$ (very high) and network efficiency of 0.577 (high) together characterize a system that is well-positioned for sustained performance in dynamic conditions.

5.2 Prioritized Recommendations

The organization demonstrates healthy dynamics across all primary indicators. The recommended course of action centers on preservation and monitoring:

Priority 1 -- Ongoing: - Maintain the current efficiency-resilience balance; avoid optimization initiatives that would push alpha above the viability ceiling - Conduct regular assessments to confirm stability and detect early drift

Priority 2 -- Short-term (3 to 6 months): - Document current network configurations and practices as an organizational baseline - Develop contingency protocols that leverage existing redundancy pathways

Priority 3 -- Medium-term (6 to 12 months): - Benchmark against peer organizations to validate competitive positioning - Explore separate analysis of distinct flow types (information, resources, authority) for deeper insight

5.3 Future Assessment

To strengthen the evidence base, the following extensions are recommended: longitudinal tracking of these metrics at regular intervals to identify trends and cycles; comparative benchmarking against industry peers using the same framework; separate analysis of distinct flow types (information, resources, authority) where data permits; and dynamic modeling to develop predictive scenarios for organizational evolution.

The Ulanowicz-Fath framework's grounding in information theory and decades of ecological validation provides a robust complement to traditional performance measurement. As organizational environments grow more complex and volatile, the ability to quantify the balance between efficiency and adaptability becomes increasingly material to strategic decision-making.

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Appendix: Detailed Data

A1. Node-Level Statistics

#	Node Name	In-Flow	Out-Flow	Total Flow
1	Plants	2003.00	8881.00	10884.00
2	Detritus	9883.00	5112.00	14995.00
3	Bacteria	3479.00	890.00	4369.00
4	Detritivores	1814.00	275.00	2089.00
5	Carnivores	330.00	2351.00	2681.00

Table A1. Node-Level Flow Statistics — Disaggregated inflow and outflow volumes for each node in the network, enabling identification of dominant actors and potential bottlenecks.

A2. Assessment Categories

Category	Assessment
Sustainability	VIABLE - Leaning toward organization
Robustness	HIGH - System demonstrates strong robustness
Resilience	GOOD - Adequate resilience mechanisms
Efficiency	OPTIMAL - Efficiency within sustainable range
Regenerative Potential	HIGH - Strong regenerative capabilities

Table A2. Metric Assessment Categories — Classification of each computed metric into qualitative assessment bands (e.g., Healthy, Developing, Critical) used throughout this report.